

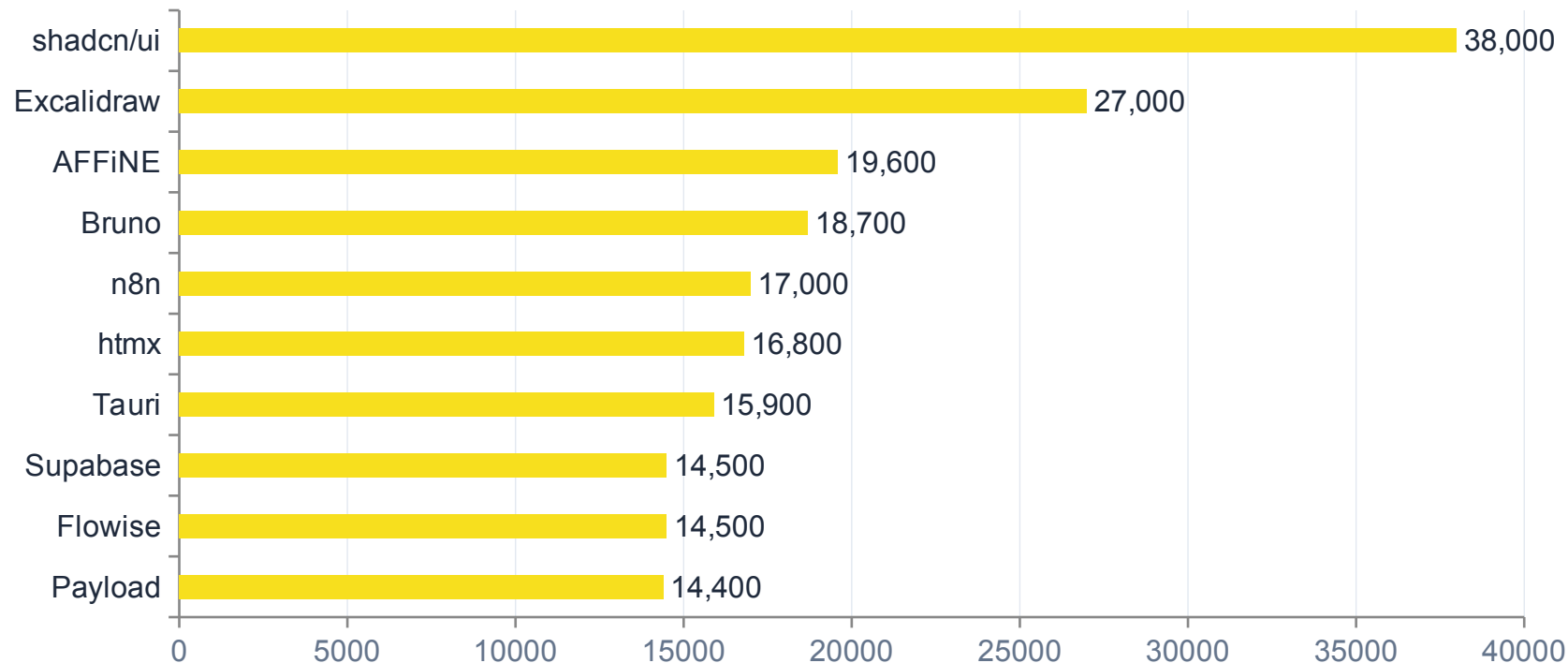
2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated list

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars

Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win Again

77.5k total stars

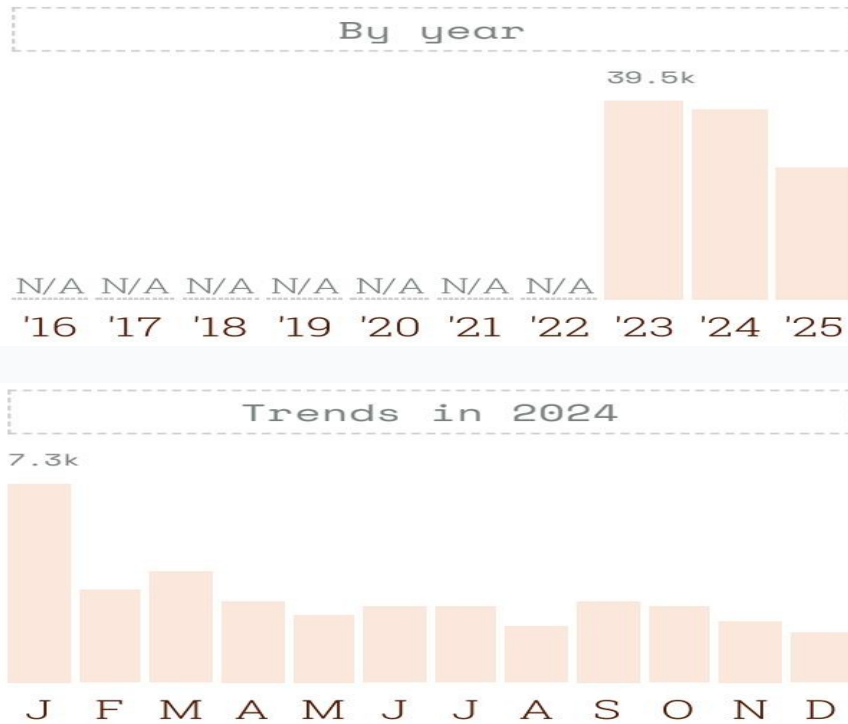
Created January 2023

Growth Trajectory

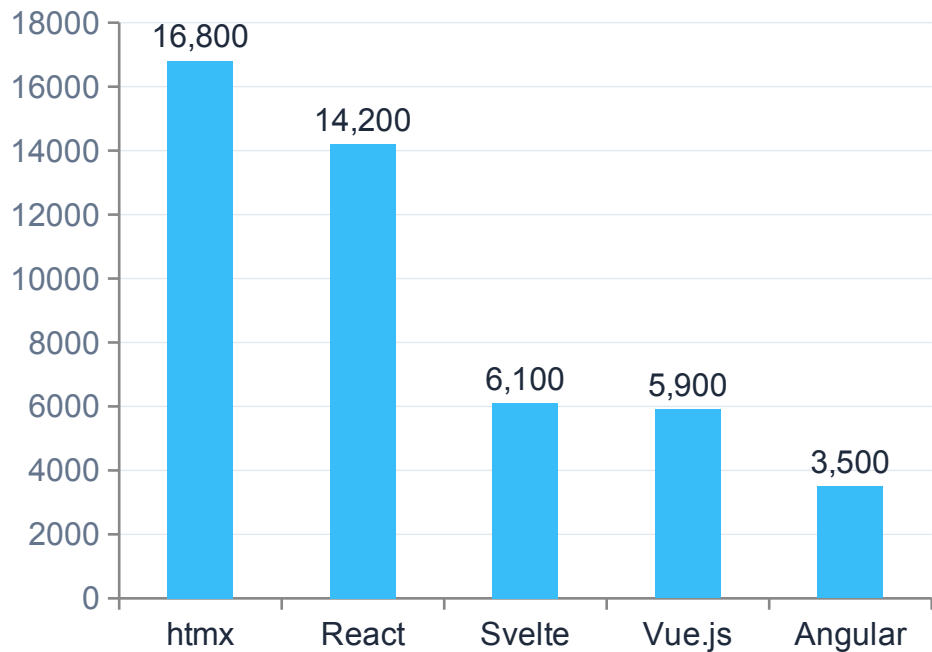
- +39.5k stars in 2023
- +38.0k stars in 2024

Key 2024 Additions

- Charts (powered by Recharts)
- Themes & Blocks
- Responsive Sidebar
- Multi-framework CLI (Next.js, Vite, etc.)



htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework



htmx (+16.8k)

Extends HTML with hx-* attributes. Enables data fetching & interactivity without writing JS. Ideal for server-driven apps.

React 19 (+14.2k)

Launched Dec 2024. Added Server Components, Server Functions, custom elements support. Shifting toward a 'framework specification'.

Svelte 5 (+6.1k)

Introduced 'runes' for explicit reactive state.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui & Excalidraw Dominate

Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	shadcn/ui	+38.0k
2	Excalidraw	+27.0k
3	Payload	+14.4k
4	Magic UI	+13.2k
5	Next.js	+12.1k

Evolution of React

- **From Library to Spec:** Multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix) now interpret React's primitives differently.
- **Server Components:** Moving rendering back to the server for performance.
- **Ecosystem Shift:** UI copy-paste (shadcn/ui, Magic UI) dominating over traditional component libraries.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes

Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	Nuxt	+6.2k
2	PrimeVue	+5.4k
3	Slidev	+4.7k
4	shadcn-vue	+4.1k
5	VitePress	+3.7k

Vue's Maturing Landscape

- **Vue 3.5 Overhaul:** Reactivity system reworked with lighter 'alien-signals' approach.
- **Flourishing UI Libraries:** Strong performance from PrimeVue and shadcn-vue signals ecosystem confidence.
- **Nuxt Leads:** Active release cycle and performance focus keeps it at #1.

AI Tools, Desktop, and Browser Innovation

AI Integration

AI is now table stakes for major projects.

- **n8n (+17k)**: Workflow automation with native AI.
- **Flowise (+14.5k)**: Visual builder for LLM flows.
- **AFFiNE (+19.6k)**: AI-powered knowledge base.

Desktop Apps

Web tech moving beyond the browser.

- **Tauri (+15.9k)**: Continued push for lighter desktop/mobile apps built with web frontends.

A lighter, safer alternative to Electron gaining strong enterprise adoption.

Browser Powers

Heavy lifting shifting to the client.

- **PGlite**: Full Postgres via WebAssembly.
- **WebVM**: Virtual machine running entirely in the browser.
- **Supabase (+14.5k)**: Open-source backend fueling these front-ends.

Key Takeaways: Looking to 2025

1. Component Ownership > Imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model proves developers want full control of their UI code.

2. HTML-First is Serious

htmx's #1 spot validates server-driven, low-JS architectures.

3. React is a Framework Specification

React 19 makes it a set of primitives for meta-frameworks like Next.js.

4. AI Integration is Table Stakes

Four of the top 10 projects have significant AI capabilities natively.